

THE STARRY STRIPES OF WOMEN

Masaba Gupta,
Founder, House of Masaba

» Talking about the stereotypes that men cast on women of being too high-strung to take practical decisions, Gupta said that it is usually women's biggest strength that allows them to be prolific multi-taskers and managers

» Highlighting the importance of financial security in women's lives, she said that the ability to earn is a great enabler for women to make independent decisions and to be treated as equal to men

» Further, calling men to action to take the initiative in ensuring an equal footing for women, she said that treating women well should be taught to people from a young age



A CHANGING DEALSCAPE

Aabha Bakaya (left), Presenter and Senior Editor, BT TV;
Vineeta Singh, Co-founder & CEO, SUGAR Cosmetics

» Shedding light on the dearth of funding available to women-led businesses and start-ups, Singh said that only 1 per cent of the total capital invested in start-ups is available to them, while only 2 per cent of women-led businesses receive those funds

» Talking about the changing consumer landscape, Singh said that earlier, brands were focussed on trust and consistency, but in the past few years with GenZ as the core consumers, brands are evolving their community connects, purpose and story

» Singh said that entrepreneurship is like a marathon and not a sprint. Hence, failures should push people to keep going



FIXING THE PIPELINE FOR WOMEN WORKERS

(From left) **Sourav Majumdar**, Editor, *Business Today*, with

Zia Mody, Co-founder & Managing Partner, AZB & Partners

Swati Piramal, Vice Chairperson, Piramal Group

Arundhati Bhattacharya, Chairperson and CEO, Salesforce India

» Stating that almost 46 per cent of women drop out of the workforce annually, Mody said that even if the number is taken down to 20 per cent, its impact on the country's GDP will be significant

» Agreeing with Mody, Bhattacharya said the root cause of women leaving the workforce needs to be resolved with

customised solutions, otherwise it'll be difficult to retain talent

» Speaking of the importance of women in leadership roles, Piramal said that the environment should be made hospitable for women at the workplace, and that it should not just be about women's development, but women-led development